Keystone Family Housing Partners

Helping families move from shelter into homes that last

STATUS	501(c)(3) public charity, Connecticut
FOUNDED	2009
BASED IN	West Haven, CT (small office), serving Greater New Haven
SERVES	Families with children experiencing homelessness
ANNUAL BUDGET	About $640,000 (including rental assistance passed through to landlords)
STAFF	Executive director, 4 case managers, 1 housing locator, part-time finance manager
VOLUNTEERS	About 20 (move-in help, donated furniture)
REACH	About 70 families (around 220 people) housed per year

MISSION

Keystone helps families experiencing homelessness find a stable home quickly and gives them the support to keep it.

OUR STORY

Keystone began as a church committee that furnished apartments for families leaving shelter. Over time it added case management and short-term rental assistance, and it now participates in the regional homeless response system.

WHO WE SERVE

Families referred through the region's coordinated entry system, mostly single mothers with young children. Many have experienced eviction, domestic violence, or a sudden job loss.

PROGRAMS

Rapid Rehousing
Help finding an apartment, first month's rent and security deposit, and declining rental assistance for up to 12 months.

Stay Housed Case Management
Weekly home visits for six months, then monthly: budgeting, landlord issues, benefits, child care, and school enrollment.

Fresh Start Furniture
Volunteers collect donated furniture and set up apartments before move-in day.

HOW WE'RE FUNDED

Federal homelessness funds passed through the regional system (55%), state housing funds (20%), foundations (15%), individual and congregational donors (10%).

WHAT WE TRACK TODAY

Required entries in the regional homeless management information system (HMIS): enrollments, exits to permanent housing, length of time homeless. Case managers track home visits. Keystone rarely looks at its own data beyond required reports.

WHAT WE'RE WRESTLING WITH

Keystone has lots of required data but no clear story. The board wants to know whether families are still housed a year after assistance ends, and whether the case management makes a difference beyond the rent help.

A MOMENT FROM OUR WORK

A mother and her two sons moved into a two-bedroom apartment after four months in shelter. A year later she called her old case manager, not for help, but to say she'd been promoted to shift supervisor. (Details changed to protect privacy.)